

ClassE US language guide

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Why this matters

Purpose: This guide flags the words a US educator can hear as outdated, controversial or unintentionally offensive, and gives the word to use instead, in every call, demo, deck and email.

Goal: US buyers hear a partner who shares their beliefs about students and teachers, and they trust ClassE with their students.

We know that US buyers are skeptical of edtech. Many have been burned before, so they look for signals, good or bad.

Results come first. But buyers also need to know we think the way they do. They answer to their community for every choice they make with public money, and a vendor they choose becomes part of that choice. So they look for a partner that works from the same principles.

A district that buys ClassE is saying, "This is the best place to spend public funds for our kids." So we have to be above reproach.

What matters most is not the words. It is the mindsets behind them, and these beliefs are ours. This guide helps us say them the way US educators say them.

Most of the Not lines in this guide come from our own calls, including some of Christopher's. They work in Israel. A US buyer hears them differently, so we keep the idea and change the words.

Use this guide in three ways:

- Before a call or demo, read "The short version."
- Before a deck, one-pager or email goes out, check any word you are unsure of in the word list.
- During a call, if a word goes wrong, use one of the lines in "If a word goes wrong in the call."

You will not remember everything. If you read one part, read the short version.

Before this goes to the team: nine decisions for Matt and Joe

This guide flags some words we have used ourselves, including in the workshop takeaways and in the product. Before it goes to the team, we need your call on each one. Each row shows the word, what the guide recommends, and how a US buyer may hear it. Once you decide, this section comes out, and the word list is updated to match.

#	Word we have used	The guide recommends	How a US buyer may hear it
1	"Learning diagnosis and intervention platform"	Describe ClassE by what students do in it, which is practice, and by the second question.	"Diagnosis" and "intervention" are district words. "Intervention" means a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program. Buyers who heard labels like this said, "Oh, so you're i-Ready."
2	Diagnosis and progress monitoring as steps in the ClassE cycle	Keep the cycle, and name the steps plainly: practice, the second question, what the teacher sees, the teacher's next step, more practice.	"Diagnose" sounds like a disability evaluation. Progress monitoring is the district's process, tied to IEP goals and tiered support.
3	"One learning activity with multiple instructional functions" (practice, formative evidence, diagnostic insight, remediation)	Name the one thing ClassE does in that district.	Each label invites a comparison to a different product.
4	"Support any curriculum"	"Curriculum-aligned," only where ClassE is set up for that curriculum.	A buyer will test "any" on their own curriculum.
5	"Tier 1 support, and tools for Tier 2 and Tier 3 intervention"	"ClassE provides data a district may use within its MTSS process."	Tiers are the district's system. A vendor does not place itself in one.
6	"Acceleration"	"Targeted practice."	In Texas, acceleration is a program set in state law, with minimum hours and tutor ratios.
7	"Exercise"	"Practice," "practice questions."	Understood, but it reads as translated. Matt prefers "exercise," so this one is your call.
8	"Save time for teachers"	"It takes grading tasks off the teacher's plate."	We have no number yet, and a principal can hear that the teacher will have less to do.
9	"Mastery" on the ClassE report, off one question	A product decision: what the report calls a correct answer, and a skill shown over time.	"Mastery" off one question is an overclaim. "Proficient" and "Masters" are state test labels. The report is on screen in every demo, and a rep cannot talk around it.

The short version

Our core beliefs

1. **Every child can, and will, grow.** Every child can make radical growth in the right conditions. Our job is to help build those conditions.
2. **Kids do well if they can.** This is an idea from Ross Greene, a US psychologist. A student who is struggling is missing a skill, not the will. When a student has a learning gap, it means we have not found the right way yet. Never, ever because the kid does not want to.
3. **We never blame students or families.** Nothing we say can be heard as blaming kids or not believing in them. We never blame parents. Families are our partners.
4. **Every student is an individual.** We see each student as an individual. We never generalize about a child from a group or from one story. A student's culture, language and community are strengths the student brings.

Every section in this guide reflects one or more of these beliefs.

Three things to remember

- "We help the student up to the question. We don't bring the question down to the student."
- "The teacher leads. ClassE supports."
- "We don't have a study on that yet. Here's what we can show you."

Seven kinds of words that land wrong

- **Words that label a child.** Describe what the student did. "Let's look at what each student did."
- **Words that are out of date.** Use today's word, and the buyer's word first. "English learner," not "ESL student."
- **Words that undercut teachers.** "The teacher leads. ClassE supports."
- **The district's words.** Tiers, IEPs, diagnosis, intervention and progress monitoring name what the district runs, never what ClassE is. "Your team decides which support each student gets. ClassE gives your team data."
- **Politically charged words.** Do not raise them. If the buyer uses one, follow their lead.
- **Claims we have not measured, and sales talk.** "We don't have a study on that yet. Here's what we can show you."
- **Words that sound translated.** "Practice," not "exercises." "Scores," not "marks."

Before the call

- Check the state, and whether you are meeting a district, a charter network or one school. Then read "Texas and New York, side by side."
- If a report on screen says "mastery," say what it shows: "These students got this question right."
- Do not mention Albert or text to speech until the team confirms they work in the US product.

If a word goes wrong in the call

- "What do you call this in your schools?"
- "I may be missing local context. How does this work in your schools?"
- "Let me say that more carefully."
- "I don't know. I'll find out and get back to you."

The seven kinds, with examples from our calls

1. Words that label a child

We describe what each student did. We never rank students, and we never generalize from a group or from one story.

Say "Let's look at what each student did."

Not "It's very helpful to engage these kids."

Why The sentence is kind. "These kids" still turns individual students into a group.

Say "Seven students missed this skill. The teacher can teach them in a small group."

Not "Closing the gaps with the weakest students."

Why Closing the gaps is a good goal. "The weakest students" ranks children.

Say "This student missed these three questions. Here is what the teacher sees next."

Not "He's got competency issues across the board."

Why "Competency issues" labels the child. Describe the answers.

2. Words that are out of date

Some words that were standard a few years ago now sound careless in a US school. We let the school, network or district name things first, then we use the same word. We never correct how a buyer talks about its own students.

Say *in Texas*: "Your emergent bilingual students."

Not "Your ESL students."

Why ESL is still the program name in Texas, so it sounds right. It is not a name for the child.

Say "A student with a disability."

Not "We can help ADHD students."

Why In the US, most people name the student first and the disability second. Some autistic and Deaf people prefer to name the identity first. If a family uses its own word, use theirs.

Say The buyer's own word for its students and programs.

Not A correction of it.

Never repeat what one district says about itself to another district, such as "Closing the gaps, we were an F."

3. Words that undercut teachers

Nothing we say puts the software above the teacher, in place of the teacher, or in judgment of the teacher.

Say "The teacher leads. ClassE supports." Say it early in the meeting.

Not "The platform is teacher-proof."

Why In some countries this is a selling point. In a US school it says the vendor thinks the teacher is the problem.

Say "You can see which students missed which skill, so you know which students to teach in a small group and what to reteach."

Not "We want to save time for teachers, and not only save time, but make them better teachers."

Why It says the teachers are not good enough today.

Say "ClassE shows the teacher sooner which students missed which skill. The teacher decides what to do."

Not "ClassE finds gaps faster than teachers can."

Why The speed is real. But "than teachers" puts the software in a race with the teacher.

When teachers are in the room, talk to them, not about them: "You see which students missed which skill. You decide what to do next."

4. The district's words

Some words name what the district runs, never what ClassE is, even when they would be accurate. Tiers, IEPs, 504 plans, intervention, progress monitoring and diagnosis belong to the district. So do "mastery" and "proficient" as results.

Say "Your team decides which support each student gets. ClassE gives your team data."

Not "We are doing exercises plus a Tier 1 type of remediation."

Why Tiers are the district's system. A vendor does not place itself in one, even if the description fits.

Say "The student got these questions wrong on this skill. This is where we focus next."

Not "We can do 10 exercises and diagnose exactly what the problem is."

Why "Diagnose" sounds like a doctor. Only an evaluation, with the parent's consent, decides whether a student has a disability. ClassE never stands between a child and an evaluation.

Say "The student got these questions right on this skill."

Not "80% of the class got that question right, so 80% has achieved mastery in that standard."

Why A US buyer hears "mastery" and "proficient" as results the state test gives. One question cannot carry them.

Say *once the team confirms text to speech works in the US product:* "ClassE has accessibility supports, like text to speech. Whether a support matches an accommodation in a student's IEP or 504 plan is for that team to decide."

Not "We could upload an IEP and use it to tweak how the system works."

Why An IEP is a confidential student record. The line also says ClassE carries out the plan. Only the IEP or 504 team decides accommodations.

Say "When a student misses a question, ClassE asks a second question on the same skill, written a different way. The second question shows the teacher whether the student misses the skill again."

Not "We are a diagnostic and remediation tool."

Why The first label decides which product the buyer compares ClassE to. Buyers who heard labels like this answered, "Oh, so you're i-Ready."

Say *if a buyer asks "So you're like i-Ready?":* "Some parts are similar. Let's show you what happens after a student misses a question. We help the student up to the question. We don't bring the question down to the student."

"Targeted practice" and "data-informed" are safe for ClassE. If the district says "remediation" first, use it too. Do not use several assessment words for ClassE at once. Name only what ClassE does in that district.

5. Politically charged words

In both states, do not bring up DEI or parental rights as a topic. If the buyer uses a word first, follow their lead. The rules differ by state, so read "Texas and New York, side by side" before the call.

Say What ClassE does for each student.

Not "An equity engine that dismantles traditional testing and builds belonging."

Why Never describe ClassE as doing equity work itself, in either state.

Our calls have not touched race. If it comes up, do not raise it, and never guess about a child from race, language, neighborhood or income.

6. Claims we have not measured, and sales talk

If ClassE has no study for it, we say so. Then we say what we can show instead.

Say "What we can show you is which questions your students got right and wrong, on which skills, this week, against your own curriculum. We don't have a study yet on whether it raises scores."

Not "A measurable increase in the summative scores and the ratings overall for the class and for the school."

Say "It takes grading tasks off the teacher's plate. We don't have a number yet for how much time it saves."

Not "It saves a lot of time for the teachers."

Why A principal may hear that the teacher will have nothing to do. Name the task instead.

Say "Schools in Israel use it. We don't have a controlled study of its effect on grades yet."

Not "Thousands of kids that use ClassE in Israel have better grades, better results."

Why It is not evidence that ClassE caused it, and a US buyer will ask how we know.

Say "The student got these questions wrong on this standard. The teacher can step in here, and ClassE gives the student more practice on it."
Not "We analyze each answer and identify exactly where the student's reasoning is breaking down."
Why It claims to see inside the student's head. We can show which answers were right and wrong.

Say *once the team confirms Albert works in the US product:* "Albert, the AI tutor, asks the student questions, so the student works it out. It is one feature of ClassE."
Not "It's like 30 personalized tutors that know your students and understand their mistakes."
Why No one can check it.

Say "We help the student up to the question. We don't bring the question down to the student."
Not "We bring the students to the test, not bring the questions down to the students."
Why "Test" sounds like teaching to the test. "Help" says the student gets support to reach the question. Without it, a special education or English learner specialist can hear "no supports." The line is about ClassE's own questions. IEP teams can still modify a student's work.

7. Words that sound translated

These are understood, but they mark the speaker as not from here.

Say "Practice," "practice questions."
Not "Exercises," "an exercise platform."

Say "Scores," "grades."
Not "Marks."

Texas and New York, side by side

The same word can be safe in one state and risky in the other. Check the state before the call, and whether you are meeting a district, a charter network or one school.

	Texas	New York and the Northeast
Law and policy	SB 12, a Texas law limiting DEI work in K-12 schools, in effect since September 1, 2025.	The Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education Framework, New York State guidance since 2018.
Equity words	Do not raise equity, DEI or identity words. If the district uses one, follow its lead.	Many schools use equity, identity and asset framing words. Some have grown quieter about them since 2025. Follow the buyer's lead, and say what ClassE does for each student. Never claim ClassE is itself culturally responsive.
How to open	"ClassE gives students practice on the TEKS, once we set it up with you."	"ClassE gives students practice on your curriculum and your standards, once we set it up with you."
State test	STAAR. Use the name the district uses. Its top level is "Masters Grade Level," so Texas educators say "masters" as an official label. Never use "mastery" for a ClassE result.	The New York State tests.
English learners	"Emergent bilingual" for the student. "ESL" or "bilingual" for the program.	"Multilingual learners/English language learners (MLLs/ELLs)" for the student. "ENL" for the program.

In New York, using a buyer's own words about equity is not the same as raising DEI.

Word list, A to Z

Look up a word before you use it. Each row gives the kind of word (from the seven above), what to say instead, and why. "Decision" and a number mean the row waits on that decision above.

Word or phrase	Kind	Say instead	Why
"30 personalized tutors"	Claim	"Albert, the AI tutor, asks the student questions, so the student works it out." Once Albert is confirmed for the US.	No one can check it.
"Acceleration," for ClassE (Decision 6)	District's word	"Targeted practice." Use "acceleration" only for the district's own program.	In Texas it is a program set in law, with minimum hours and tutor ratios.
"ADHD students," "cognitive issues," "students with different diagnosed learning disabilities"	Out of date	"A student with a disability," or what the student needs.	A student's disability category is private.
"Any curriculum" (Decision 4)	Claim	"Curriculum-aligned," only where ClassE is set up for that curriculum.	A buyer will test it on their own curriculum.
"Assessment platform," "diagnostic and remediation tool," "formative assessment platform," "learning diagnosis tool" (Decision 1)	District's word	"Practice." Then describe the second question.	The first label decides which product the buyer compares ClassE to.
"At risk," "low performing," about a student	District's word	"Students who have not shown this skill yet."	In Texas, at risk is a legal category. Low performing is a federal term for schools.
"Bring the students to the test," "the exact model of what they're going to see on that test"	Sales talk	"We help the student up to the question." "We align the practice to your standards and your state assessment."	It sounds like teaching to the test.
"Competency issues," "his skills lack"	Labels a child	"This student missed these three questions."	It labels the child. Describe the answers.
"Data-driven"	Undercuts teachers	"Data-informed."	It sounds like the numbers make the decisions.
"Depends a lot on the quality of the teachers"	Undercuts teachers	Do not raise it.	It judges the buyer's staff.
"Diagnose," "diagnostic," for ClassE (Decisions 1 and 2)	District's word	"The student got these questions wrong on this skill. This is where we focus next."	It sounds like a disability evaluation, which only the district runs, with the parent's consent.
"Drill and kill," or any other product, run down	Sales talk	Describe what ClassE does.	The district may use that product.

Word or phrase	Kind	Say instead	Why
Equity, DEI and identity words, in Texas	Charged	Do not raise them. If the district uses one, follow its lead.	Texas law limits DEI work in K-12 schools.
"Equity engine," "culturally responsive," for ClassE	Charged	What ClassE does for each student.	Never describe ClassE as doing equity work itself.
"ESL students"	Out of date	"English learner" or "multilingual learner." In Texas, "emergent bilingual." In New York, "MLLs/ELLs."	ESL is a program, not a name for a child.
"ESL has been expunged in Texas"	Claim	The district's own program name.	TEA still runs bilingual and ESL programs.
"ESSA certified"	Claim	"We don't have a study yet that meets ESSA Tiers 1 to 3."	ESSA tiers rate research studies. No product is ESSA certified.
"Evidence-based," loosely; "validated," alone	Claim	"Evidence-informed design." Say what was validated against what.	A US buyer will ask for the study.
"Exercises," "an exercise platform" (Decision 7)	Translated	"Practice," "practice questions."	It reads as translated.
"Faster than teachers"	Undercuts teachers	"ClassE shows the teacher sooner which students missed which skill."	It puts the software in a race with the teacher.
"I don't see color"	Out of date	Do not raise race.	It is an older American idea of equality. Today it can sound like not seeing the student.
"Identify exactly where the student's reasoning is breaking down"	Claim	"Here are the questions the student got wrong on this skill."	It claims to see inside the student's head.
"Intervention," "intervention platform," for ClassE (Decision 1)	District's word	"Targeted practice." "ClassE provides data a district may use within its MTSS process."	A US buyer hears a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program. The teacher intervenes. ClassE does not.
"LEP"	Out of date	"English learner."	Federal law replaced it with "English learner."
"Make them better teachers"	Undercuts teachers	"You can see which students missed which skill."	It says the teachers are not good enough today.
"Marks"	Translated	"Scores," "grades."	It reads as translated.
"Mastered," "achieved mastery," "increased mastery," for a ClassE result (Decision 9)	District's word	"A correct response." For a skill over time: "They got most questions on this standard right, over several weeks."	One question cannot carry it. Keep "mastery" for the school's own goal.

Word or phrase	Kind	Say instead	Why
"Meets FERPA," "meets WCAG," or any standard	Claim	"I'll find out and get back to you."	Not until the product team confirms it. Buyers worry about student data inside an AI system.
"Needs help," "competent," as labels for a student	Labels a child	"The student got more of these questions right this week."	It labels the child.
"Neurodivergent student," as the general term	Out of date	What the student needs.	It is a word some people use about themselves. Follow the family's lead.
"One student's story" ("she had a 44, then went up to a 60")	Claim	"That's one student's result. It's not proof yet."	One story is not evidence, and it generalizes from one child.
"Pretty good student," "she's a strong student"	Labels a child	"This student got these questions right on this skill."	Praise is still a judgment about the child.
"Proficient," "masters of this skill," for a ClassE result (Decision 9)	District's word	"They got most questions on this standard right, over several weeks."	These are state test labels.
"Progress monitoring," for ClassE (Decision 2)	District's word	Describe the evidence in plain words.	It is the district's process, tied to IEP goals and tiered support.
"Proven," "proof positive"	Claim	"We don't have a study on that yet. Here's what we can show you."	A US buyer will ask for the study.
"Remediation," for ClassE	District's word	"Targeted practice." Use "remediation" if the district says it first.	It is the district's word to choose.
"A revolution in education," "something you couldn't do 4 or 5 years ago"	Sales talk	Describe what the AI does.	No one can check it.
"The same difficulty as the first," for the second question	Claim	"A second question on the same skill."	No field-test data or item statistics show it yet.
"Saves a lot of time for teachers" (Decision 8)	Claim	"It takes grading tasks off the teacher's plate."	No number yet, and a principal may hear the teacher will have nothing to do.
Spanish support, shown with a joke about your own accent	Labels a child	Answer the question plainly, in the district's words.	It ties a language to a group of people, and it is not evidence.
"Special accommodations for special needs kids"	District's word	"ClassE has accessibility supports, like text to speech." Once text to speech is confirmed for the US.	Accessibility is not special education. Only the IEP or 504 team decides accommodations.
"Special needs kids," "SPED student"	Out of date	"A student with a disability."	Name the student first.
"Teacher-proof"	Undercuts teachers	"The teacher leads. ClassE supports."	It says the vendor thinks the teacher is the problem.

Word or phrase	Kind	Say instead	Why
"These kids"	Labels a child	"Let's look at what each student did."	It turns individual students into a group.
"Thousands of kids in Israel have better grades"	Claim	"Schools in Israel use it. We don't have a controlled study of its effect on grades yet."	It is not evidence that ClassE caused it.
Tiers: "a Tier 1 type of remediation," "your Tier 3 kids," "tier to tier" for scores (Decision 5)	District's word	Tiers only for what the district runs. For scores: "score band," "performance level."	Tiers are the district's system, never a name for ClassE or a student.
"Upload an IEP"	District's word	Do not offer it.	An IEP is a confidential student record.
"Weak students," "strong students," "a GAP student," "the weakest students"	Labels a child	"Each student gets practice on the skill they missed."	It ranks children.

Appendix

US terms used in this guide

Term	Meaning
504 plan	A plan under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act, for a student with a disability who needs accommodations.
ENL	English as a New Language, the New York program name.
ESSA	Every Student Succeeds Act, which sets the evidence tiers.
FERPA	Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act, on student records.
IDEA	Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, the special education law.
IEP	Individualized Education Program.
MTSS	Multi-Tiered System of Supports.
RTI	Response to Intervention.
STAAR	The Texas state test.
TEA	Texas Education Agency.
TEKS	Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills, the Texas standards.
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines.

Sources

- At risk: Texas Education Code 29.081.
- Emergent bilingual: Texas Education Code 29.052.
- Acceleration: Texas HB 4545 and HB 1416.
- LEP: ESSA replaced LEP with "English learner" in 2015. Some federal rules still use it.
- SB 12: in effect since September 1, 2025.
- Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education Framework: New York State guidance since 2018.
- Student data in New York: Education Law 2-d requires a data privacy agreement before a district can use the product.
- STAAR: Texas will replace it with shorter tests under a 2025 law.
- Neurodivergent: not one of the 13 IDEA disability categories.
- Kids do well if they can: Ross Greene.